Sékou Metiki

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Education

Ph.D. in Quantitative Economics, Kiel University (CAU), Germany — expected Dec. 2026
Dissertation: *The Missing Middle: Measuring Africa's Middle Class and Its Demand for Democracy*

M.S. in Economics, African School of Economics (ASE), Abomey-Calavi, Benin — 2020

B.A. in Economics, École Nationale d'Économie Appliquée et de Management (ENEAM), Cotonou, Benin — 2018

Fields

Development Economics, Political Economy, Machine Learning

Job Market Paper

Where the Windfall Lands: Export Booms and the Demand for Democracy in Africa

Export booms can increase household resources or strengthen dependence on benefits controlled by the state. I examine their relationship with democratic demand across African districts where farming is more or less common, linking fixed crop maps and world prices to 125,659 Afrobarometer respondents in 22 countries. A one-standard-deviation three-year boom has a fitted demand response 0.025 standard deviations more positive where the district farming share is 25 percentage points higher; crop-history tests do not reject at the 10 percent level after adjustment. Aligned area-level consumption comparisons do not verify an accompanying resource gain, leaving income transmission unresolved.

Working Papers

Estimating Middle-Class Shares in Afrobarometer Using Survey-to-Survey Imputation

Mapping Africa's Middle Class Across Space (with Tobias Heidland)

Preparing for FX Intervention (with Tobias Heidland and Lukas Menkhoff). Revise and resubmit, *Journal of Money, Credit and Banking*

Research Experience

Researcher, Kiel Institute for the World Economy, Kiel, Germany — 2021–present
DYNAMIG project (Horizon Europe, 2023–2025): multi-country online survey on living conditions and migration attitudes in Africa

Researcher, DIW Berlin, Germany — 2022–2023

Research Assistant, Institute of Empirical Research in Political Economy (IREPE), Cotonou, Benin — 2020–2021

Research Assistant, Center of Research and Support – Advice for Developments, Cotonou, Benin — 2020

Teaching Experience

Assistant Lecturer, Effects of Globalization in Developing Countries, Kiel University — 2023–2024

Assistant Lecturer, Econometrics, African School of Economics, Benin — 2021

Assistant Lecturer, Mathematics (Bachelor), African School of Economics, Benin — 2019

Bachelor's thesis support on occupational aspirations using NEPS data

Skills

Programming R, Python, Stata, QGIS, LaTeX
Languages French (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate)

References

Prof. Dr. Tobias Heidland
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Prof. Dr. Leonard Wantchekon
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Prof. Dr. Lukas Menkhoff
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